

quotation from Daniel Yankelovich, about giving too much credence to counting numbers:[14](#)

*The first step is to measure what can be easily measured. This is okay as far as it goes. The second step is to disregard that which cannot be measured, or give it an arbitrary quantitative value. This is artificial and misleading. The third step is to presume that what cannot be measured really is not very important. This is blindness. The fourth step is to say that what cannot be measured does not really exist. This is suicide.*

I'm convinced that this quotation is as true today as it was then, and more relevant than ever. Business organizations must learn that "not everything that can be counted counts." Yet today we rely too heavily on counting and not nearly enough on trusting. It is time—well past time, in fact—to strike a healthier balance between the two.